SMM
Shanghai Metals Market

SMM IRON ORE DAILY

# SMM Iron Ore Daily

2026-10-13 Tuesday · Imported & Domestic Ore · Prices · Supply–Demand · Inventory · Commentary

Source **SMM / SGX**

## Futures Contracts

SGX: latest price · DCE: close

**SGX Iron Ore Current-month Contract** Latest price

**90.65** USD/dmt

FEFV26 · 2026-10 · SGX

As of preparation: 2026-10-13 18:00:33 (UTC+8)
Quote time: 10-13 17:39:38 (UTC+8)

**DCE Iron Ore Most-traded I2701** Daily

**677.0** yuan/mt

▼ -6.0 -0.88%

MTD avg **681.2**

As of Oct 13 · vs Oct 12

## SMM Iron Ore Price Index

Five MMi indices as of Oct 13

| Index | Value | Change | MTD avg |
|---|---|---|---|
| MMi 61% Port Spot Daily | 657 yuan/wmt | ▼ -4 -0.61% | 662 |
| MMi 58% Port Spot Daily | 619 yuan/wmt | ▼ -3 -0.48% | 624 |
| MMi 65% Port Spot Daily | 821 yuan/wmt | ▼ -3 -0.36% | 825 |
| MMi 61% Seaborne Index Daily | 89.50 USD/dmt | ▼ -0.30 -0.33% | 91.01 |
| MMi 65% Seaborne Index Daily | 108.70 USD/dmt | ▼ -0.80 -0.73% | 110.05 |
| SMM Domestic Ore Composite Index Daily | 821.58 yuan/mt | ▼ -3.22 -0.39% | 823.19 |

As of Oct 9 · vs Oct 8

## Key View

### Seaborne prices soften after a rebound; cost relief still needs sustained buying support

**Renewed price weakness suggests that the previous seaborne rebound has not translated into sustained market support.** DCE most-traded closed at 677.0 yuan/mt, down 0.88%, while the 61%, 58% and 65% port indices fell to 657, 619 and 821 yuan/wmt. The seaborne 61% index eased to USD 89.50/dmt and the 65% to 108.70, narrowing the grade spread to USD 19.20. Eleven of the 12 seaborne brands declined, leaving the recovery in mainstream fines fragile.

Costs and supply flows offer some cushion. The second coke cut has taken effect and C3 and C5 freight continued to fall, while the latest shipments and arrivals both declined. However, the impact of cost relief on buying appetite still depends on finished-steel selling prices, end-user orders and mill margins. Lower supply flows must also be assessed against existing port stocks and collection rates rather than equated directly with tighter spot availability.

**The immediate focus should be the persistence of transactions and restocking.** Buying limited to immediate needs could make one-day rebounds difficult to sustain and keep ore prices range-bound at low levels. A combination of margin repair and stronger orders could gradually generate additional purchases and support prices. For now, cost improvement should be distinguished from demand improvement, and gains in individual brands should not be treated as an overall trend reversal.

## Today's Highlights

- **Domestic futures eased and most port spot quotations fell.** DCE most-traded I2701 closed at **677.0 yuan/mt**, down 6.0 yuan (-0.88%) from Oct 12. Qingdao PB Fines were 645, Newman Fines 648 and Mac Fines 649 yuan/wmt, each down 3 yuan; Carajas Fines held at 831 yuan/wmt.
- **Seaborne indices declined and the grade spread narrowed.** The 61% seaborne index was **USD 89.50/dmt**, down 0.30 (-0.33%), and the 65% was **108.70**, down 0.80 (-0.73%). Their spread narrowed from USD 19.70 to 19.20/dmt.
- **Most seaborne brands fell as the previous rebound failed to continue.** Against the Oct 12 report, PB Fines were USD 89.80/dmt (-0.33%), Newman Fines 88.90 (-0.34%) and Mac Fines 89.25 (-0.17%). Eleven of the 12 brands declined, while Jimblebar Fines rose USD 0.15 to 85.45 (+0.18%).
- **All three port spot indices moved lower.** The 61%, 58% and 65% indices were 657, 619 and 821 yuan/wmt, down 4, 3 and 3 yuan from the previous readings. The 65%-58% spread held at 202 yuan/wmt, with softer composite prices coexisting with differences across individual brands.

## Qingdao Port Imported Ore Spot Prices

yuan/wmt · tax incl.

| Product | 10-13 (yuan/wmt) | Daily change / % | MTD avg | Last 12 months |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **PB Fines** 60.8% Daily | 645 | ▼ -3 -0.46% | 649 | |
| **Newman Fines** 61.2% Daily | 648 | ▼ -3 -0.46% | 652 | * |
| **Mac Fines** 60.8% Daily | 649 | ▼ -3 -0.46% | 651 | |
| **BRBF** 62.5% Daily | 695 | ▼ -3 -0.43% | 700 | |
| **Newman Lump** 63% Daily | 840 | ▼ -3 -0.36% | 844 | |
| **Super Special Fines (SSF)** 56.5% Daily | 507 | ▼ -3 -0.59% | 511 | |
| **Carajas Fines (IOCJ)** 65% Daily | 831 | — 0 0.00% | 830 | |
| **PB Lump** 61.5% Daily | 831 | ▼ -3 -0.36% | 840 | * |

## Seaborne Brand Prices in USD & MMi Indices

USD/dmt

### Seaborne Brand Prices in USD CFR Qingdao

| Product | 10-13 (USD/dmt) | Daily change / % | 10-12 |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Roy Hill Fines** 62% Daily | 86.15 | ▼ -0.35 -0.40% | 86.50 |
| **SIMEC Fines** 61% Daily | 87.85 | ▼ -0.20 -0.23% | 88.05 |
| **PB Fines** 62% Daily | 89.80 | ▼ -0.30 -0.33% | 90.10 |
| **Newman Fines** 60.7% Daily | 88.90 | ▼ -0.30 -0.34% | 89.20 |
| **Mac Fines** 60.5% Daily | 89.25 | ▼ -0.15 -0.17% | 89.40 |
| **Jimblebar Fines** 60.30% Daily | 85.45 | ▲ +0.15 +0.18% | 85.30 |
| **Carajas Fines (IOCJ)** 65% Daily | 104.80 | ▼ -1.70 -1.60% | 106.50 |
| **SSFT / SSFG** 60% Daily | 94.90 | ▼ -1.70 -1.76% | 96.60 |
| **Brazilian Blend Fines (BRBF)** 64% Daily | 95.10 | ▼ -1.55 -1.60% | 96.65 |
| **RTX Fines** 61% Daily | 84.60 | ▼ -0.45 -0.53% | 85.05 |
| **West Pilbara Fines (WPF)** 60% Daily | 89.25 | ▼ -0.20 -0.22% | 89.45 |
| **SP10 Fines** 59%-60% Daily | 77.90 | ▼ -0.80 -1.02% | 78.70 |

### SMM Iron Ore Price Index monthly statistics

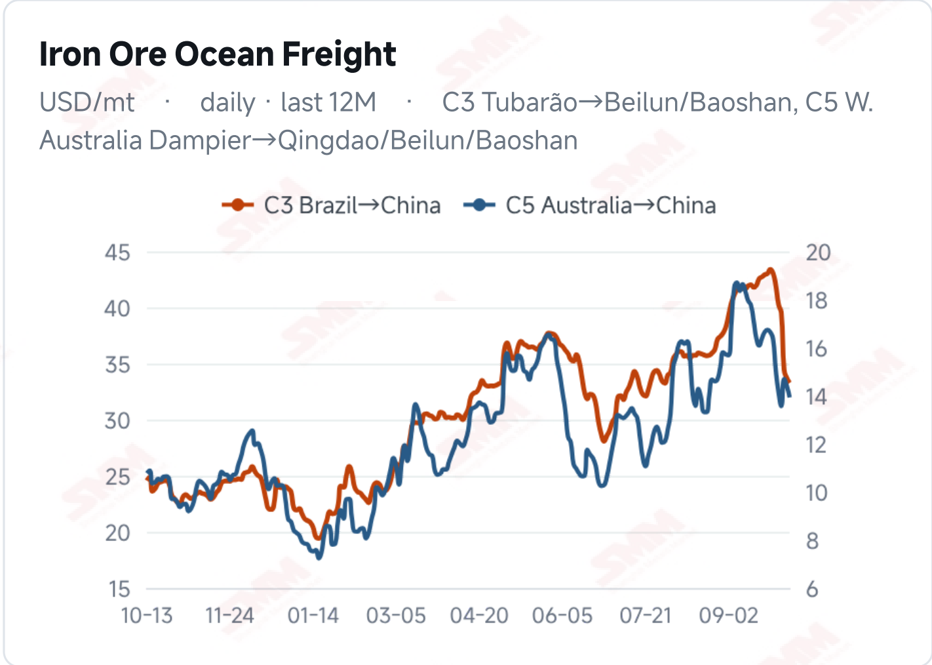
| Index | Month-to-date avg | MoM | YTD | Unit | Last 12 months |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **SMM MMi 61% Iron Ore Seaborne Index** Daily | 91.01 | -5.69% | -15.5% | USD/dmt | |
| **SMM MMi 65% Iron Ore Seaborne Index** Daily | 110.05 | -3.83% | -10.4% | USD/dmt | |
| **SMM MMi 61% Iron Ore Port Spot Index** Daily | 662 | -4.43% | -19.2% | yuan/wmt | |
| **SMM MMi 65% Iron Ore Port Spot Index** Daily | 825 | -1.71% | -8.7% | yuan/wmt | |
| **SMM MMi 58% Iron Ore Port Spot Index** Daily | 624 | -3.65% | -13.8% | yuan/wmt | |
| **SMM China Domestic Ore Composite Price Index** Daily | 823.19 | -1.83% | -7.3% | yuan/mt | |

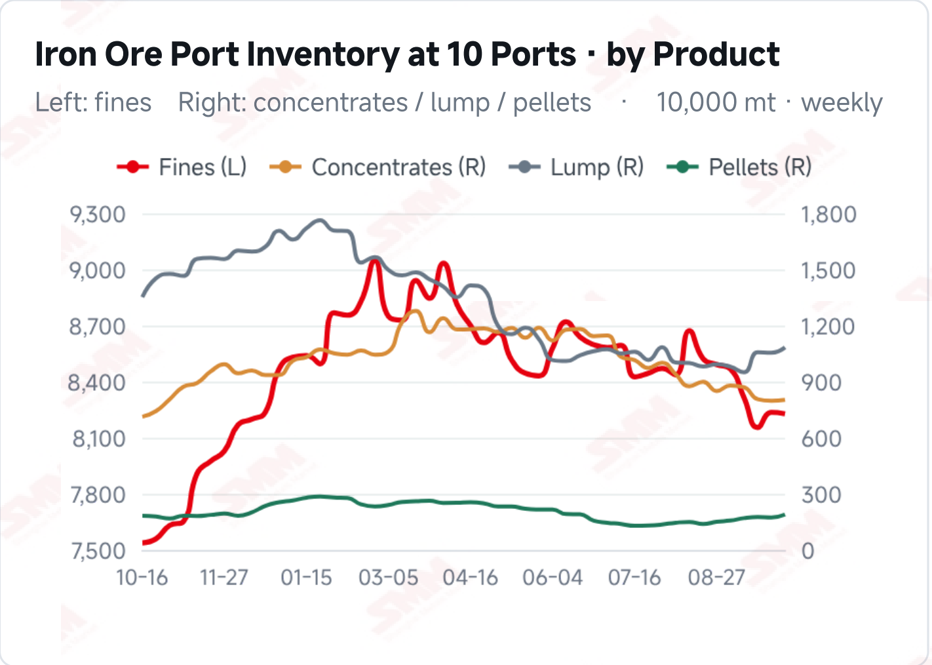
The seaborne 61% index was USD 89.50/dmt (-0.33%) and the 65% was 108.70 (-0.73%), narrowing their spread from USD 19.70 to 19.20/dmt. The 61%, 58% and 65% port indices were 657, 619 and 821 yuan/wmt, down 4, 3 and 3 yuan from the previous readings.

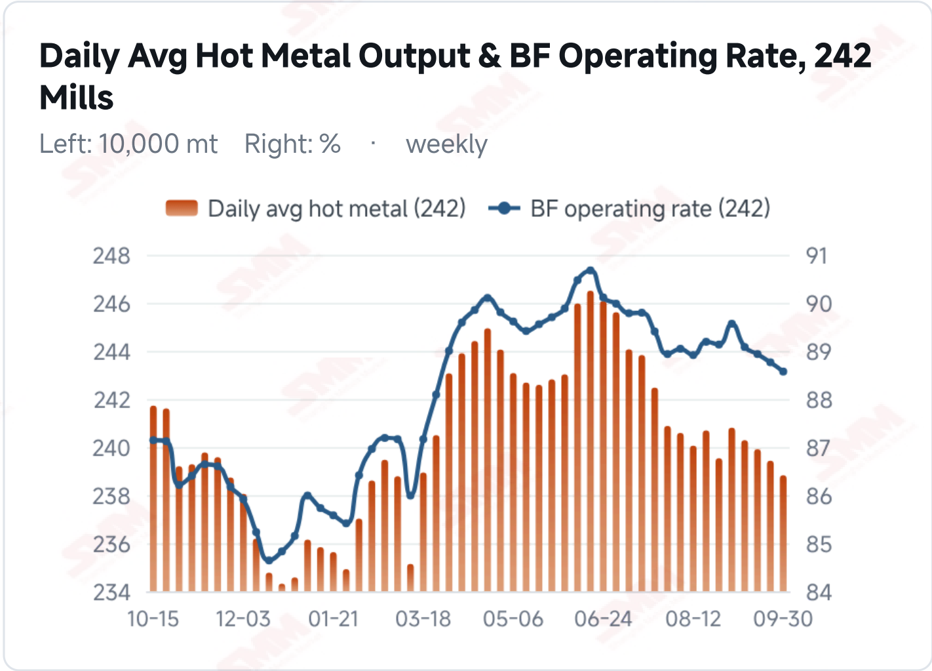
* SMM yuan quotations for Newman Fines and PB Lump start in Mar 2026; their sparklines cover that shorter window only. All others show the past year.

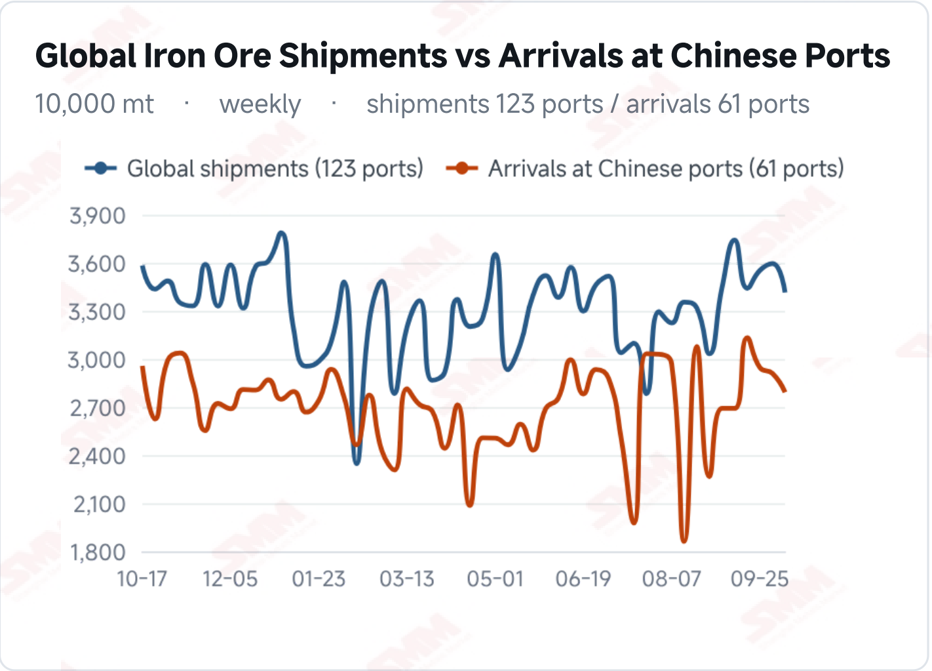
## Key Price Drivers

Last 12 months


**Iron Ore Ocean Freight**
USD/mt · daily · last 12M · C3 Tubarão→Beilun/Baoshan, C5 W. Australia Dampier→Qingdao/Beilun/Baoshan


**Iron Ore Port Inventory at 10 Ports · by Product**
Left: fines Right: concentrates / lump / pellets · 10,000 mt · weekly


**Daily Avg Hot Metal Output & BF Operating Rate, 242 Mills**
Left: 10,000 mt Right: % · weekly


**Global Iron Ore Shipments vs Arrivals at Chinese Ports**
10,000 mt · weekly · shipments 123 ports / arrivals 61 ports

## Market Commentary · Imported Ore

**Futures & spot** DCE most-traded I2701 closed at 677.0 yuan/mt, down 0.88% from Oct 12. Qingdao PB Fines were 645, Newman Fines 648, Mac Fines 649, BRBF 695, Newman Lump 840, SSF 507 and PB Lump 831 yuan/wmt, each down 3 yuan; Carajas Fines were unchanged at 831. The latest price for SGX official current-month contract FEFV26 was USD 90.65/dmt, timestamped Oct 13, 17:39:38 (UTC+8).

**Drivers** Seaborne quotations softened again after the previous day's broad recovery, alongside declines in domestic futures and composite port indices, showing that the price recovery lacks persistence. Lower costs may ease some pressure on mills, but end-user orders, finished-steel prices and actual purchases jointly determine demand support. Gains in individual brands should not be read as a broad improvement in demand; transaction volumes and restocking schedules remain important.

**Demand** SMM's Oct 13 review cited projected hot metal output losses from blast furnace maintenance of 1.9011 million mt for Oct 10–16, up 78,600 mt WoW, highlighting the constraint from maintenance schedules. This covers a week still in progress rather than a realised decline in daily hot metal. Mill enquiries were reasonable but overall transactions remained limited, with purchases focused on immediate needs. The second coke cut has taken effect, but additional buying still depends on finished-steel margins and orders.

**Inventory & supply** In the week to Oct 9, global shipments were 34.1393 million mt, down 5.02% WoW, and arrivals in China were 27.9147 million mt, down 4.05%. Brazil shipped 7.0226 million mt and Australia 19.5081 million mt. Lower supply flows may ease subsequent pressure, although existing port stocks and mill purchasing rates remain important to the balance. The latest available 10-port inventory was 103.0165 million mt as of Sep 30.

**Cost & margin** Oct 12 freight was USD 33.26/mt for C3, down USD 0.42 (-1.25%) from the previous reading, and 13.92 for C5, down USD 0.47 (-3.27%). Lower transport costs may improve landed cost conditions for some cargoes. The second coke purchase-price cut offers mill cost relief but does not establish that mills have returned to profit; finished-steel selling prices and procurement costs must be assessed together. SMM's current imported ore cost-and-margin assessment put the average import margin at 9.60 yuan/mt, down 5.77 yuan from 15.37; this measures import trading rather than steelmaking profitability.

## Market Commentary · Domestic Ore

**Prices** The latest Domestic Ore Composite Price Index was 821.58 yuan/mt on Oct 9, down 0.39% from the previous reading. Softer imported ore prices may continue to influence bargaining room for domestic concentrates.

**Supply & demand** SMM's Oct 12 Shandong brief reported 64% basic concentrate at 759 yuan/mt on a dry-basis, pre-tax ex-mine quotation payable by acceptance bill, down 12 yuan from the previous week. Mill collections returned to a normal pace, some miners saw slower sales and some contract suppliers had little inventory pressure. Region, grade and payment terms distinguish this market from the domestic composite index.

**Outlook** Cautious mill buying could slow mine destocking and price recovery. Conversely, gradual margin improvement from cost relief could support domestic concentrate demand. Near-term attention should remain on regional transactions and purchasing intensity rather than extrapolating individual local quotations to the national market.

## Market Factors

### ▲ Supportive factors

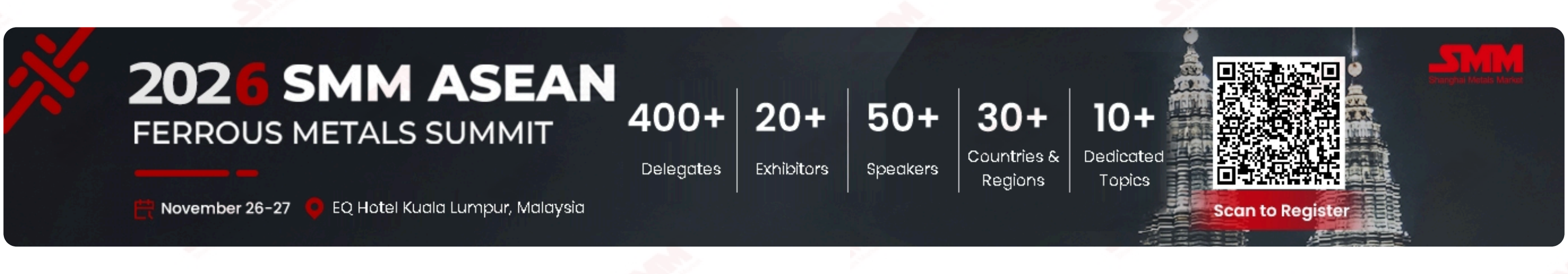
- The latest global shipments and arrivals in China both declined.
- Lower C3 and C5 freight reduced transport costs for some cargoes.
- The second coke cut provides a cushion for mill costs.
- Regional resource differences may support some individual brands.

### ▼ Bearish factors

- DCE closed 0.88% lower and all three port indices declined.
- Both seaborne indices and most brand quotations softened.
- End-user demand and finished-steel profitability continue to constrain buying appetite.
- The previous seaborne rebound did not persist, limiting evidence of a durable recovery.

## Flash News

- [SMM Iron Ore] Maintenance losses climb to 1.9 million mt as lower freight erodes cost support ↗
  2026-10-13
- [SMM Iron Ore] Softer spot prices narrow imported iron ore margins to 9.60 yuan/mt ↗
  2026-10-13
- [SMM Coking Coal and Coke Daily Briefing] 20261013 ↗
  2026-10-13
- [SMM Steel] India Domestic Steel Prices Decline Amid Weak Buying ↗
  2026-10-13
- [SMM Steel] Indian HRC and Billet Prices Hold Steady Amid Festive Slowdown ↗
  2026-10-13
- [SMM Steel] Indonesian HRC Flat at $515/mt FOB as Weak Demand Leaves Mills with Little Pricing Power ↗
  2026-10-13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FERROUS METALS SUMMIT
November 26-27 EQ Hotel Kuala Lumpur, Malaysia
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20+ Exhibitors
50+ Speakers
30+ Countries & Regions
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